Berkeley International School Curriculum Policy

Academic Year 2026 - 2027 ·

Version 4.0 · Implementation date: August 2026

Authorisation

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1. School Philosophy

1.1 Vision and Mission

Vision: To create a learning community that empowers students to be lifelong learners and global citizens prepared for success in the 21st century.

Mission: Berkeley provides all students with a rigorous, personalized and modern education in a safe and supportive learning environment, empowering students to develop confidence, responsibility, critical thinking, creativity, and problem-solving skills needed to succeed in college, careers, and life, and to contribute to the ever-changing local and global community.

1.2 School Motto

Dream, Believe, Achieve - Inspiring students to set ambitious goals, maintain confidence in their abilities, and work persistently toward meaningful accomplishments.

1.3 School Philosophy: Learning with Lasting Impact

Berkeley International School recognizes that meaningful education extends beyond subject knowledge to develop a broad range of skills, values, attitudes, and behaviors that prepare students for life success.

1.4 Cambridge Learner Attributes

Our curriculum fosters five essential attributes in students:

- **Responsible:** Understanding the impact of actions on others and the environment, and making ethical decisions.
- **Reflective:** Evaluating personal learning strategies and growth, and adjusting approaches accordingly.
- **Confident:** Exploring ideas critically and communicating views effectively, with clarity and conviction.
- **Innovative:** Meeting challenges with creativity and resourcefulness, taking thoughtful risks and adapting flexibly.
- **Engaged:** Demonstrating curiosity and appreciating diverse perspectives through questioning, exploration, and respectful engagement.

2. Curriculum Framework

2.1 Cambridge Curriculum and Project-Based Learning Integration

Our curriculum combines the academic rigor of Cambridge programs with project-based learning (PBL) to create an active learning environment that:

- **Engages students in real-world challenges** by connecting classroom learning to authentic situations.
- **Develops critical thinking and problem-solving skills** through analysis, evaluation of evidence, and solution design.
- **Fosters independent thinking and research skills** by building students' capacity to formulate questions and draw reasoned conclusions.
- **Builds collaborative capabilities** by strengthening teamwork, shared responsibility, and common goals.

2.2 Core Learning Objectives

- **Foster a love of learning** – enthusiasm and intrinsic motivation for knowledge.
- **Develop strong academic foundations** – comprehensive subject knowledge that supports advanced study.
- **Nurture critical thinking and problem-solving** – systematic approaches to analyzing challenges.
- **Promote responsible global citizenship** – awareness of global issues and active community participation.
- **Embrace cultural understanding** – appreciation of diverse perspectives, traditions, and values.

2.3 Core Subject Development

- **Language Arts:** Khmer, English, and Chinese communication skills across reading, writing, speaking, and listening.
- **Mathematics:** Computational fluency, logical reasoning, and application of mathematical thinking to real-world situations.
- **Science:** Physics, Chemistry, and Biology through inquiry-based approaches.
- **Global Perspectives:** Integrated History, Geography, and Civics education.
- **Information and Communication Technology (ICT):** Digital literacy and critical awareness of information sources.
- **Robotics (Lower and Upper Secondary):** Computational thinking, engineering design, and hands-on problem solving through building and programming.
- **Business Studies (Upper Secondary and Advanced Levels):** Principles of commerce, management, and entrepreneurship.

2.4 Co-Curricular Disciplines

- **Physical Education:** Healthy lifestyles, physical fitness, motor skills, and positive attitudes toward lifelong activity.
- **Art:** Creativity and self-expression through visual media; observational skills and cultural awareness.
- **Music:** Musical skills, teamwork, and emotional expression through performance and listening.

3. Academic Programs and Pathways

3.1 Academic Calendar and Assessment Schedule

The academic year runs from August to early June, providing a full instructional year aligned with international school calendars. Dates for 2026–2027 are to be confirmed by the Academic Office before issue.

Term	Dates	Instructional days
Term 1	August 3 to October 2	44 days
Term 2	October 5 to December 18	45 days
Term 3	January 11 to March 19	47 days
Term 4	March 22 to June 4	47 days

Cambridge Checkpoint and external examinations are administered in the May / June series, following completion of instruction.

Cambridge Educational Pathway. Berkeley follows the complete Cambridge pathway:

- **Cambridge Early Years (ages 0.5–5):** Foundation stage focused on holistic, play-based development.
- **Cambridge Primary (ages 5–11, Years 1–6):** Fundamental skills, with the Cambridge Primary Checkpoint at the end of Year 6.
- **Cambridge Lower Secondary (ages 11–14, Years 7–9):** Subject expertise, with the Cambridge Lower Secondary Checkpoint at the end of Year 9.
- **Cambridge Upper Secondary (ages 14–16, Years 10–11):** Specialization through Cambridge IGCSE qualifications.
- **Cambridge Advanced (ages 16–18, Years 12–13):** Cambridge International AS Level (Year 12) and A Level (Year 13), completing the full continuum.

Dual curriculum structure by age

Age	Cambridge year	Khmer grade	Assessment / note
2	Pre-nursery	Pre-K	Readiness assessment; portfolio-based evaluation
3	Nursery	K1	Pre-literacy and numeracy
4	Reception	K2	School readiness evaluation. **Graduation benchmark: IP Early Years**
5	Year 1	K3	Foundational literacy and numeracy assessment (Stage 1)
6	Year 2	Grade 1	Reading fluency checkpoint; basic math skills evaluation (Stage 2)
7	Year 3	Grade 2	Comprehensive assessment in English, Math, Science (Stage 3)
8	Year 4	Grade 3	Progress monitoring; critical thinking evaluation (Stage 4)
9	Year 5	Grade 4	Pre-checkpoint preparation assessment (Stage 5)
10	Year 6	Grade 5	Cambridge Primary Checkpoint (English and Math). **Graduation benchmark: IP Year 6**
11	Year 7	Grade 6	Transition assessment; subject-specific evaluations (Stage 7)
12	Year 8	Grade 7	Progress monitoring; pre-checkpoint preparation (Stage 8)
13	Year 9	Grade 8	Cambridge Lower Secondary Checkpoint (English, Math, Science). **Graduation benchmark: IP Year 9**
14	Year 10 (IGCSE Y1)	Grade 9	IGCSE preparation
15	Year 11 (IGCSE Y2)	Grade 10	IGCSE examinations
16	Year 12 (AS Level)	Grade 11	AS Level examinations. **Graduation benchmark: IP Year 12**
17	Year 13 (A Level)	Grade 12	A Level examinations. **Graduation benchmarks: IP Year 13 and Khmer Program Grade 12**

Assessment framework notes

- **Continuous assessment:** Ongoing formative assessment at all levels.
- **External examinations:** Cambridge Checkpoint, IGCSE, AS Level and A Level.
- **Internal examinations:** School-based summative assessments at key transition points.
- **Diagnostic assessments:** Conducted as needed to support individual learning needs.

3.2 Early Years Program (Ages 0.5–5)

- **Approach:** Learning through structured, guided play and age-appropriate activities that develop foundational cognitive, social, and physical skills.
- **Focus:** Three prime areas (Communication and Language, Physical Development, Personal/Social/Emotional Development) and four specific areas (Literacy, Mathematics, Understanding the World, Expressive Arts and Design).
- **Completion:** The IP Early Years stage concludes with a graduation benchmark (see Section 3.6).

3.3 Cambridge Primary (Ages 5–11, Years 1–6)

- **Lower Primary (Years 1–3):** Literacy, numeracy, and exploratory learning through hands-on discovery.
- **Upper Primary (Years 4–6):** Expanded subject knowledge, progressing to the Cambridge Primary Checkpoint.

Weekly structure: 27 sessions of 50 minutes. (1 session per week = 32.5 hours per year.)

Subject	Sessions per week	Hours per year
English	6	195
Mathematics	4	130
Science	3	97.5
Global Perspectives	3	97.5
Chinese	4	130
ICT	3	97.5
Art	1	32.5
Physical Education	1	32.5
Music	1	32.5
Swimming	1	32.5
Total	**27**	**877.5**

Students also follow the National Cambodian Program (Section 6.2), which includes additional mathematics instruction.

3.4 Cambridge Secondary (Ages 11–16, Years 7–11)

Lower Secondary (Years 7–9). Core subjects: English, Mathematics, Science, Global Perspectives, ICT, Chinese, and Robotics. Co-curriculum: Music and Physical Education. Art is not timetabled in Lower Secondary. The stage culminates in the Cambridge Lower Secondary Checkpoint at the end of Year 9, which is also a graduation benchmark.

Subject	**Sessions per week**	**Hours per year**
English	6	195
Mathematics	5	162.5
Science	5	162.5
Global Perspectives	3	97.5
ICT	3	97.5
Chinese	3	97.5
Art	0	0
Physical Education	2	65
Music	1	32.5
Robotics	2	65
Total	**30**	**975**

Upper Secondary (Years 10–11, IGCSE). Specialized IGCSE study in English as a Second Language and Literature, Combined Sciences (Biology, Chemistry, Physics), Mathematics, Business Studies, ICT, and Global Perspectives, alongside Chinese and Robotics (school-based courses) and Physical Education. IGCSE examinations are sat at the end of Year 11 (IGCSE Year 2).

Subject	**Sessions per week**	**Hours per year**
English	6	195
Mathematics	5	162.5
Science	4	130
Global Perspectives	3	97.5
Business Studies	3	97.5
ICT	2	65
Chinese	3	97.5
Physical Education	2	65
Robotics	2	65
Total	**30**	**975**

Advanced Levels (Years 12–13, AS and A Level). Students study Cambridge International AS Level in Year 12 and A Level in Year 13, together with school-based Chinese.

Subject	Sessions per week	Hours per year
English	5	162.5
Mathematics	4	130
Biology	3	97.5
Global Perspectives	2	65
Business	2	65
Media & Design	2	65
Chinese	2	65
Total	**20**	**650**

Important note for secondary grading: In Secondary School (Years 7–11), co-curricular subjects (Art, Music, Physical Education) are assessed for learning purposes but do not appear on report cards or contribute to GPA calculations. Only core academic subjects are included in formal reporting and GPA computation.

3.5 Advanced Pathways (AS and A Level)

Berkeley delivers Cambridge AS Level in Year 12 and A Level in Year 13, giving students comprehensive preparation for university admission globally. Year 13 completion marks graduation from both the Cambridge and the national systems.

3.6 Graduation Benchmarks

Berkeley recognizes the following graduation benchmarks. Each marks the completion of a defined stage and is recorded on the student's academic record.

Benchmark	Stage completed	Evidence
IP Early Years	End of Reception (Early Years stage)	School readiness evaluation and portfolio
IP Year 6	Cambridge Primary	Cambridge Primary Checkpoint
IP Year 9	Cambridge Lower Secondary	Cambridge Lower Secondary Checkpoint
IP Year 12	Cambridge AS Level	AS Level examinations
IP Year 13	Cambridge A Level	A Level examinations
Khmer Program Grade 12	National Cambodian Program	Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport requirements, including national examination

Requirements for IP graduation benchmarks: completion of the stage in good standing, participation in the stage's Cambridge assessment, and the minimum standards in Section 4.3. Year 11 (IGCSE) results are certified by Cambridge but Year 11 is not a graduation benchmark.

4. Assessment and Evaluation

4.1 Assessment Framework

Formative assessment (ongoing, not graded):

- Class discussions and participation
- Quizzes and short assignments
- Observation of student work
- Self-reflection and peer review

Summative assessment (graded):

- **Authentic GRASP performance tasks (Terms 1–3):** Goal-oriented, Role-based, Audience-specific, Situation-authentic, Product-focused tasks.
- **Multidisciplinary projects (Terms 1–3):** Synthesis of learning across subject boundaries.
- **Cambridge standardized exams (Term 4):** International benchmarking and preparation for external assessments.

Reporting structure:

- Four terms per academic year.
- Term weighting: 20% each for Terms 1–3, and 40% for Term 4 / final exams.
- Regular parent-teacher conferences.
- Comprehensive report cards covering academic achievement and learner attributes.

4.2 Grading Policy and Academic Standards

Berkeley employs a letter grade system aligned with Cambridge Assessment International Education standards.

Grade	E	D	C	B	B+	A	A+
Score	0–59%	60–69%	70–79%	80–84%	85–89%	90–94%	95–100%

Grade definitions:

- **A+ (95–100%):** Exceptional achievement exceeding school standards.
- **A (90–94%):** Excellence exceeding school standards.
- **B+ (85–89%):** Achievement exceeds school standards.
- **B (80–84%):** Achievement meets school standards with merit.
- **C (70–79%):** Achievement meets school standards.
- **D (60–69%):** Achievement approaches school standards.
- **E (0–59%):** Achievement does not meet school standards.

Grading timeline:

- **Continuous assessment:** Ongoing formative evaluation (not graded).
- **Term assessments:** Summative evaluations at the end of each term.
- **Grade reporting:** Formal grades issued at the conclusion of each term.

Grade weighting: Terms 1 - 4 at 25% each

Grade modification and appeals:

- Parents may request a grade conference within 10 school days of report card distribution.
- Formal grade appeals must be submitted in writing to the Academic Office within 15 school days.

Reporting and communication: Full report cards are issued at term conclusion, with parent-teacher conferences following each distribution. Report cards include letter grades with percentage ranges, specific comments on progress and areas for improvement, and next steps for continued growth.

4.3 Progress Monitoring and Intervention

Cambridge preparation standards. Students must maintain minimum grade requirements for examination eligibility:

- **Cambridge Checkpoint (Years 6 and 9):** Minimum C average in core subjects.
- **Cambridge IGCSE:** Minimum C average with no E grades in examination subjects.

5. Curriculum Implementation

5.1 Teaching and Learning Approaches

- **Individualized instruction:** Methods and pace adapted to different learning styles, abilities, and interests.
- **Project-based learning:** Extended investigations of authentic challenges with tangible outcomes.
- **Active learning:** Hands-on, applied experiences through which students construct understanding.
- **Interdisciplinary connections:** Integration across subjects to build holistic understanding.

5.2 Technology Integration

- **BYOD policy:** Managed personal device use for educational purposes.
- **No mobile phone policy:** Focused learning environments with minimal distraction.
- **Digital platforms:** Google Classroom as the primary learning management system.
- **Digital citizenship:** Integrated lessons on ethical, safe, and effective technology use.

5.3 Extracurricular Activities

- In-house and external competitions (sports, chess, spelling bee).
- Art exhibitions and performances.
- Educational field trips aligned with curriculum objectives.

6. Dual Curriculum Structure

6.1 Cambridge International Program

- English-medium instruction following Cambridge curriculum frameworks.
- Structured progression through Cambridge Primary, Lower Secondary, IGCSE, and AS and A Level.
- Emphasis on learner-centered approaches and critical thinking.

6.2 National Cambodian Program

- Khmer-medium instruction aligned with Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport requirements.
- Complete coverage of Cambodian curriculum objectives, preparing students for national examinations.
- Integration of traditional Cambodian values and cultural elements.
- Graduation at Khmer Program Grade 12 (see Section 3.6).

6.3 Bilingual Instruction

- English-medium instruction for the Cambridge curriculum, developing academic English through immersive content learning.
- Khmer-medium instruction for National Curriculum components, maintaining cultural identity and meeting local requirements.

7. Cambridge IGCSE and AS Level Implementation

7.1 IGCSE Subject Offerings (Years 10–11)

Subject	Syllabus code
English as a Second Language	0991
English Literature	0992
Mathematics	0580
Sciences – Co-ordinated (9–1)	0973
Business	0264
Information and Communication Technology	0983
Global Perspectives	0457

7.2 AS and A Level Subject Offerings (Years 12–13)

Subject	Syllabus code
AS English Language	9093
Mathematics	9709
Biology	9700
Cambridge International AS & A Level Business	9609
Digital Media & Design	9481
Global Perspectives & Research	9239

7.3 Staff Qualifications for IGCSE and A Level Delivery

- All IGCSE and A Level teachers hold relevant subject degrees and qualifications.
- Minimum 2 years' experience teaching the Cambridge curriculum.
- Regular participation in Cambridge professional development webinars.

7.4 Resources and Facilities

- **Science:** Fully equipped laboratories with appropriate safety equipment for required practicals.
- **ICT:** Computer laboratory with up-to-date hardware and software aligned with syllabus requirements.
- **Library:** Textbooks, reference materials, and digital resources supporting IGCSE and AS/A Level syllabi.
- **Assessment materials:** Past papers, mark schemes, and examiner reports available to teachers and students.

7.5 Examination Administration

- **Examination Officer:** Martin Islas - responsible for exam integrity and procedures.
- **Secure storage:** Academic Assistant, Sovanpanha Ngoeuen -locked facilities meeting Cambridge standards.
- **Staff training:** Curriculum Coordinator, Martin Islas - regular updates for invigilators and administrators.
- **Malpractice prevention:** Curriculum Coordinator, Martin Islas - clear protocols and supervisory procedures.
- **Access arrangements:** Campus Manager - provisions for students requiring special considerations.

7.6 Academic Integrity

Berkeley is committed to academic integrity in alignment with Cambridge standards, defined as **honesty** (work is the student's own, with ideas acknowledged), **trust** (faith in the fairness of assessment), **fairness** (equal rules and opportunities), **respect** (proper citation of others' intellectual property), and **responsibility** (accountability for following the standards).

Prohibited conduct: plagiarism, collusion, misconduct (obtaining unfair advantage during assessments), and falsification of data or citations.

Enforcement: Violations are addressed through a graduated response system, with educational interventions for first offenses and escalating consequences for repeated violations, including assessment invalidation in accordance with Cambridge regulations. Students, parents, and staff share responsibility for maintaining these standards.

7.7 Results Analysis and Improvement

- Systematic analysis of IGCSE, AS and A Level results against global benchmarks.
- Identification of subject and topic-level strengths and weaknesses.
- Individual student performance tracking and intervention.
- Annual improvement plans based on examination outcomes.

8. Quality Assurance

8.1 Teacher Qualifications and Professional Development

- **Recruitment standards:** All teachers have relevant qualifications and experience in Cambridge programs.
- **Cambridge-specific training:** Regular participation in Cambridge professional development webinars.
- **In-house professional development:** School-wide sessions building consistent pedagogy across departments and grade levels.
- **Continuous support:** Regular collaboration with curriculum coordinators.

Induction: School policies; the Cambridge curriculum and pathways; Cambridge learning goals; Cambridge Support Hub, navigation and resources.

- **Term 1:** Constructivism; Project-Based Learning
- **Term 2:** Motivation and How to Administer Cambridge Exams
- **Term 3:** Total Participation Techniques; Higher-Order Thinking Skills and Differentiation

8.2 Continuous Improvement Framework

- Data-driven decision making: assessment results inform curriculum review and instructional planning.
- Annual curriculum review cycle, keeping all programs current and aligned with the school's mission and international best practice.

9. Conclusion

This Curriculum Policy outlines Berkeley International School's commitment to a robust, dual-curriculum education that integrates the rigor of Cambridge International programs with the cultural richness of the Cambodian National Curriculum. Our framework is built on the philosophy of "Learning with Lasting Impact", designed to cultivate confident, responsible, reflective, innovative, and engaged global citizens. Through project-based learning, individualized instruction, and a comprehensive assessment strategy, we foster a supportive and dynamic learning environment. This policy guides all stakeholders, ensuring transparency and a shared understanding of our pathways, standards, and commitment to continuous improvement.

Version Control

Version	Date	Description of changes	Authorized by
1.0	August 2021	Initial policy release	Madam Chea Neang Eng, Director General
2.0	August 2024	Updated for 2024–2025: mission, vision and international program	Madam Chea Neang Eng, Director General
3.0	June 2025	Updated for 2025–2026: Section 4	Madam Chea Neang Eng, Director General
4.0	2026	Updated for 2026–2027: grade "Not Yet" replaced by E; new graduation benchmarks (IP Early Years, Year 6, Year 9, Year 12, Year 13; Khmer Program Grade 12); revised timetables for Primary, Lower Secondary, Upper Secondary and Years 12–13; Robotics added; AS and A Level provision added; duplicate section 4.2/4.3 merged	Madam Chea Neang Eng, Director General